

THE STARTER GUIDE · v1

Using Marvex Studio

A founders'-edition pocket manual for turning every PDF, every paper, and every loose idea into a beautiful, interactive map.

What is this?

Eight short chapters covering the moves that make Marvex Studio feel like magic. Skim it once before your first session — every shortcut and right-click pattern is in here.

How long?

About 12 minutes of reading. Each chapter is one page so you can jump to whatever you need, when you need it.

marvex.app · The Ultimate Research Lab

Drop a paper. Get a map.

Marvex Studio's flagship trick is this: you drop any PDF up to 25 MB onto the canvas, and in under 60 seconds the AI of your choice (Claude, GPT, or Gemini) extracts every concept, every relationship, every hierarchy, then draws them as nodes you can drag, edit, and explore.

Your first run

- Open the Studio and click **Drop a PDF**.
- Pick any research paper, textbook chapter, or even a long article.
- Wait while the AI works — usually 30–60 seconds for a 20-page paper.
- When the map appears, click any node to expand its branch, or right-click for the full action menu.

Why it matters

Marvex Studio is not a summary tool. The AI preserves the document's **structure** — every section, every sub-claim, every supporting reference is on the canvas in the same shape the author intended. You're not reading a précis; you're navigating the original argument.

Right-click is your best friend.

Almost every action in the Studio lives behind a right-click. Master these and you'll never reach for a menu bar again.

On a node

- **Add child / Add sibling** with a 1× to 10× multiplier.
- **Edit link** to attach a file, URL, or one of your existing PDFs.
- **Pick icon** to drop any of 1,200+ icons inside the node.
- **WordArt properties** for textbox annotations — bold gradients, outlines, glow.
- **AI expand** to ask the AI for the next layer of detail.

On the canvas (empty space)

- **Insert shape / sticky / clipart / image.**
- **Connect mode** — click two nodes to draw a connector with a label between them.
- **Background picker** — choose any of the cosmic presets or upload your own.

On a connector

- **Edit colour, width, dash, arrow** — all per-edge.
- **Add label** — describe the relationship between the two nodes.

Your AI key. Your bill. Your data.

Marvex Studio never marks up inference. There's no "AI credit" system, no per-map fee, no surprise bill at the end of the month — because the AI calls go directly from your machine to the provider you choose, paid for by your key.

Where to get a key (free tiers exist)

- **Anthropic / Claude** — console.anthropic.com → API Keys
- **OpenAI / GPT** — platform.openai.com/api-keys
- **Google / Gemini** — aistudio.google.com/apikey

Setting it up

In the Studio, click **Settings** → **API Keys** → paste your key. Your key never leaves your browser; we don't have a backend endpoint that touches it. The exact same key works for PDF→Map, Map→Document, AI Expand, and global search.

Your second brain — finally searchable.

Six months from now you'll vaguely remember mapping a paper about X, but you'll have no idea which map. The global search bar (top-left of the Library) queries every node title, every annotation, every sticky, across every map you've ever made. Hit Enter and the matching node lights up on the right map automatically.

Pro moves

- Search is keyword-based by default. Quote phrases for exact matches.
- Results group by map, so you can see at a glance which document the idea originated from.
- Click a result to open the map and frame the matching node.

Every node, a launchpad.

A Marvex Studio node isn't just a box with text. Right-click → **Edit link** on any node and you can attach:

- A PDF (URL or upload) — opens in our built-in Reader where you can highlight, ink, and send selections back to the map.
- An audio file — opens in your default music app.
- A video — opens in your default video player.
- A website — opens in your default browser.
- Anything else — opens with whatever your OS associates with that extension.

We never reinvent the wheel: PDFs are the only file type we open ourselves. Everything else hands off to the app you already use and love.

Deadlines find you. Not the other way around.

Tag any node with a date (right-click → **Set reminder**) and it appears on the Calendar page — every map's reminders, talks, and follow-ups in one place. No Google account, no third-party sync. Local, private, and yours.

Common workflows

- **Submission deadlines** — tag the root node of each paper map with the conference date.
- **Reading schedule** — split a long textbook map into chapters and date-tag each one.
- **Follow-up actions** — tag the conclusion node with a two-week-out reminder to revisit.

Local-first. Cloud-friendly. Your call.

Maps live in your browser by default — no account required. When you want a backup or a collaborator, click **Cloud Save** and mirror the map to:

- **Google Drive** — as PDF, PNG, SVG, Markdown, or a binary snapshot you can re-open later.
- **Dropbox** — same exports, your folder structure.
- **Zotero** — attach the map directly to the source paper as a child item, so it shows up next time you open the reference.

Nothing is uploaded automatically. Every cloud action is one explicit click. Stop syncing and your maps live happily on local storage forever.

The cheat sheet.

Action	Shortcut
Add child node	Tab (with parent selected)
Add sibling node	Enter (with sibling selected)
Edit node text	F2 or double-click
Delete node	Delete / Backspace
Move selected node(s)	Arrow keys (Shift = larger steps)
Multi-select rectangle	Ctrl/Cmd + drag on empty canvas
Pan canvas	Hold space + drag, or middle-click drag
Zoom	Ctrl/Cmd + scroll, or pinch
Fit to screen	F or 0
Undo / Redo	Ctrl/Cmd + Z / Ctrl/Cmd + Shift + Z
Toggle Film Mode	Shift + F
Open Command Palette	Ctrl/Cmd + K

That's it. Go map something.

Reply to any of our emails with feedback, bugs, or feature wishes — every message lands in our inbox and gets read the same day. Welcome to the founders' round.

— The Marvex Studio team